But is making someone feel unhappy about themselves a sign of strength? Actually, children who bully others tend to have a low opinion about themselves. This means that there maybe things about themselves that they don't like or feel ashamed about. They therefore want to **humiliate** or put another person down in order to feel better about who they are. They think they will fit in with the crowd if they show up another's difference, even if it means picking on the other person.

Maybe Ajay is unhappy with his performance in the exams; maybe Meena doesn't like her big ears and doesn't want anyone to notice them. So, they turn their attention to Anu, who is quiet and doesn't respond. Seeing her reactions to the way they treat her makes them feel better about their own problems.



Bullying needn't always be violent like hitting someone or verbally abusing them. If a group of children always refuse to include a particular child in their games, that's bullying too! Or if you spread stories about someone and it is causing them sadness. It's quite simple – if, through your actions, you target someone repeatedly to hurt them, it is bullying. Ragging is another word for bullying.

Everyone usually knows who the bullies in a school, class, or neighbourhood are. They either avoid them out of fear or silently support them because they want to be part of the group. But it is important to know that our actions always have **consequences.**

Have you heard of the term `**peer pressure**'? Our peers are people like ourselves, usually by age or common interest. Your classmates and friends are your peers. Sometimes, you can find yourself disagreeing with something that everyone is doing but you also end up doing it because you don't want to be the odd one out. It can be something silly like praising a movie everyone's excited about but you're not. Or it can be something more serious, like ragging another child as a group even if you don't want to. There's huge pressure to act like everyone else and you give in.

Have you ever bullied anyone? Has anyone bullied you?

Children who are bullied feel **dejected** and it's easy to see why. Nobody likes to be singled out and insulted in front of others. They can lose their confidence, feel lonely and isolated.

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